

Full SOC-in-a-Box Planning & Career Strategy Chat Summary

This document summarizes your complete planning session for building a 12-week SOC-in-a-Box project, alongside key career guidance for SOC Analyst roles, beginner project rankings, and Mac-friendly tool alternatives.

SOC Analyst Career Path Overview

You explored entry-level roles in cybersecurity with a focus on SOC Analyst, including what the role involves, daily responsibilities, and career progression to Threat Intelligence Researcher.

SOC-in-a-Box Project Overview

A self-contained lab project to simulate a Security Operations Center. You discussed the goals, structure, timeline, tools, and deliverables for a full 12-week implementation. It includes log analysis, threat simulation, detection engineering, incident reporting, and MITRE ATT&CK mapping.

Tool Alternatives for macOS

Since Wazuh is not macOS-friendly, alternatives were ranked: ELK Stack (best), Zeek and Wireshark, Velociraptor, and optional VMs with Windows. ELK Stack was chosen for its SIEM-like capability and ease of use on macOS.

Timeline Revision: 3-Month Plan

You adjusted the project from 4 months to 3 months. The project was successfully compressed into a focused 12-week roadmap without losing quality.

Supporting Assets Generated

You created a project tracking spreadsheet (day-by-day goals), a GitHub-style README file, and outlined report templates and IOC logging tools. Additional resources such as a visual lab setup and PDF brief were offered.

Additional Project Ideas

You reviewed and ranked four high-impact SOC portfolio alternatives. SOC-in-a-Box remained the top pick based on hireability impact.